NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-B-14656
2 October 1992

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BUCKLE AND CATCH, CEREMONIAL, ARMY

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers belt buckles and catches used with the U.S. Army Ceremonial Uniform for both Officers and Enlisted Personnel (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The insignia covered by this specification shall be of the following types, styles and classes as specified (See 6.2).

Type I - Buckle and Catch, Ceremonial, U.S. Army, Officers
Type II - Buckle and Catch, Ceremonial, U.S. Army, Enlisted Personnel

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

NN-P-71 - Pallets, Material Handling Wood Stringer Construction 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial)
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup
UU-P-553 - Paper, Wrapping, Tissue

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in preparing this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document.

AMSC N/A FSC 8315

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MILITARY

MIL-P-15011 - Pallets, Material Handling, Wood Post Construction, 4-Way Entry

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metal, Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards and handbooks are available from: Standardization Document Order Desk, Building 4D, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY (TIOH)

B-6-6 - BELT BUCKLE AND CATCH, CEREMONIAL (EP)
B-6-6A - BELT BUCKLE & CATCH, CEREMONIAL (ENLISTED), ALTERNATE ASSEMBLY & DETAILS
B-6-32 - BELT BUCKLE AND CATCH, U.S. ARMY CEREMONIAL, OFFICERS

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figure 1, 2 and 3 are miniature copies of Institute of Heraldry drawings and are for information only.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents for a part of this document to the extend specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-D-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

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(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Non-government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other information services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated detail specifications or MS standards), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer shall furnish a standard sample of the buckle which shall be used for matching color and finish only. Variation from this specification may appear in the standard sample; however, in such cases the specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a sample of the buckle shall be submitted or made available by the manufacturer to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval before production is commenced. The approval of the first article sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article sample shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facility to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Copper base alloy. The copper base alloy shall be roll polished, free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, nicks, cracks, scratches, segregations and foreign inclusions that will not be removed in later processing. When tested as specified in 4.5.1.1, the chemical composition of the copper base alloy shall be as specified in Table I.

TABLE I. CHEMICAL COMPOSITION

ALLOY	COPPER	LEAD	IRON (MAX)	ZINC (MAX)	OTHER
Red Brass	84.0-86.0	.05	.05	Remainder	.15

3.3.2 Screw post and thumb nut. For Type II buckles, the screw post and thumb nut shall be fabricated from any type brass and shall conform to the details and dimensions of Drawing B-6-6 and B-6-6A.

3.3.3 Solder. Solder shall be a hard silver alloy solder having a melting point of not less than 1075 degrees Fahrenheit.

3.3.4 Gold for plating. Gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

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3.3.5 Lacquer. Lacquer shall be a pale clear synthetic lacquer. The use of a pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted.

3.4 Design. The embossed design of the buckle shall be an exact replica of the design on the Government furnished hubs (see 3.8), from which the contractor's working dies shall be extracted. The working die shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches or other imperfections.

3.5 Construction.

3.5.1 Type I. The buckle shall be constructed in accordance with drawing B-6-32 (see Figure 3). The buckle shall be made from red brass specified in 3.3.1.

3.5.1.1 Forcer. A forcer shall be used to bring up the design of Type I buckle. When a forcer is used, the back of the buckle shall have no sharp or rough edges or sharp corners. The impression of the forcer shall be regular and symmetrical upon the face of the buckle. Sufficient metal shall be left near the edges to assure a clean and smooth trimming.

3.5.1.2 Stamping and trimming. The embossed areas for the Type I buckle shall be struck in a manner to insure a well defined die struck edge. When applicable, embossed areas shall be trimmed and pierced to the die struck outline. All edges shall be clean and smooth, free from burrs, drag, step and rough edges. The trimming operation, when applicable, shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the design.

3.5.1.3 Soldering. All soldering shall be accomplished using solder specified in 3.3.3. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. When tested as specified in 4.6.4, the soldered parts shall not separate.

3.5.1.4 Dapping. The dap for the Type I buckle is built into the Government hub.

3.5.2 Type II. The buckle shall be constructed in accordance with drawing B-6-6 and B-6-6A (see Figures 1 and 2). The buckle shall be made from red brass specified in 3.3.1. The coat of arms shall be pierced as shown on Figure 1 and shall be dapped to fit the contour of the buckle. Two screw posts specified in 3.3.2 shall be soldered, or fused, to the back of the coat of arms on the vertical center line. The first screw post shall be one 9/32 inch $\pm$ 1/64 inch (0.71 cm $\pm$ 0.04 cm) from the top of the coat of arms and the second screw post shall be 3/4 inch $\pm$ 1/64 inch (1.91 cm $\pm$ 0.04 cm) on center from the first screw post. After finishing, the coat of arms shall be mounted on the buckle by means of two thumb nuts specified in 3.3.2. The loop for Type II may be fabricated from flat or round stock at the option of the manufacturer (see Figures 1 and 2).

3.5.2.1 Forcer. A forcer shall be used to bring up the coat of arms design for the Type II buckle. When a forcer is used, the back of the coat of arms shall have no sharp or rough edges or sharp corners. The impression of the forcer shall be regular and symmetrical upon the face of the coat of arms. Sufficient metal shall be left near the edges to assure a clean and smooth trimming.

3.5.2.2 Stamping, trimming and piercing. The embossed areas shall be struck in a manner to insure a well defined die struck edge. When applicable, embossed areas

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shall be trimmed and pierced to the die struck outline. All edges shall be clean and smooth, free from burrs, drag, step and rough edges. The piercing and trimming operations, when applicable, shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the coat of arms.

3.5.2.3 Soldering. All soldering shall be accomplished using solder specified in 3.3.3. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. When tested as specified in 4.6.4, the soldered parts shall not separate.

3.5.2.4 Dapping. The insignia and the buckle plate for Type II shall be dapped as shown on TIOH drawing B-6-6 and B-6-6A (see Figures 1 and 2).

3.6 Detail of components.

3.6.1 Type I. Type I buckle shall consist of a catch plate and a buckle plate.

3.6.1.1 Catch plate. The catch plate shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawing B-6-32 (see Figure 3). The loop shall be hard soldered in the location shown on the drawings. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the sliding bar.

3.6.1.2 Buckle plate. Buckle plates shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawings B-6-32 (see Figure 3). The loop and hook shall be hard soldered to the back of the buckle plate in the locations shown on the drawing. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the slide bar from the buckle plate to the top of the loop.

3.6.2 Type II. Type II buckle shall consist of a catch plate and a buckle plate. The buckle shall consist of embossed insignia superimposed and secured by means of two thumb nuts to the buckle plate and a catch plate assembly.

3.6.2.1 Coat of Arms. The coat of arms shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1. The finished insignia shall have a thickness of not less than 3/64 inch (0.12 cm) at the shield and shall be provided with brass screw post located as shown on drawing B-6-6 (see Figure 1).

3.6.2.2 Catch plate. The catch plate shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawing B-6-6 and B-6-6A (see Figures 1 and 2). The loop shall be hard soldered in the location shown on the drawings. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the sliding bar.

3.6.2.3 Buckle plate. Buckle plates shall be fabricated from red brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on drawings B-6-6 and B-6-6A (see Figure 1 and 2). The loop and hooks shall be hard soldered to the back of the buckle plate in the locations shown on the drawing. Care should be taken to assure free movement of the slide bar from the buckle plate to the top of the loop.

3.7 Finish. The finish on all components shall match the finish of the standard sample (see 3.1).

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3.7.1 Coat of arms. The coat of arms for Type II shall have a gold plated matte finish with burnished highlights.

3.7.2 Buckle plate.

3.7.2.1 Type I. The face of the Type I buckle plate shall be matte finish with highlights brightly polished, the back shall be clean and the entire buckle shall be gold plated.

3.7.2.2 Type II. The face of the Type II buckle plate shall be mirror-like polished, the back shall be clean, and the entire buckle shall be gold plated.

3.7.3 Catch plate. The catch plate shall have a mirror-like polished gold plated finish.

3.7.4 Gold Plating. The use of white metals as an undercoating shall not be permitted. Gold plating shall be accomplished by electroplating using gold specified in 3.3.4. Items to be plated shall be cleaned of all matter that may affect the gold plating. The gold plating shall be uniform, non-porous, continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, shaded, peeled or blistered plating. When tested as specified in 4.6.1, no visible chemical reactions, such as evolution of gases, shall appear. At the option of the manufacturer, gold plated components may be lacquered.

3.7.5 Lacquering. The obverse and reverse of finished buckles shall be lacquered as specified in 3.3.5. Each piece on Type II shall be lacquered prior to assembly. The dry lacquer film shall be continuous, level, adherent and free from lint, dust and other foreign matter. When tested as specified in 4.6.2, there shall be no change in appearance of the lacquered surface except the following will be permitted:

(a) A slight overall yellowing of the highlights.

(b) Not more than 2 dark spots, no larger than 1/16 inch (0.16 cm) diameter, widely distributed on the buckle and not more than three such additional spots shall be permitted on the edge of the buckle.

3.8 Government loaned property. Hubs shall be furnished by the Government and shall be used to make the contractor's working dies necessary for one contract or order (see 3.4).

3.9 Marking. The contractor shall stamp his trademark or other identifying mark legibly and inconspicuously on the back of the buckle tongue. There shall be no signs of penetration or unevenness on the surface opposite the marked area. The marking shall not distort any part of the buckle.

3.10 Workmanship. Buckles shall be clean, well made, and shall meet the acceptable quality level established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as

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otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspections set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements; however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspection shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.5 and 4.6.

4.4 First article sample inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article sample (see 3.2), shall be made of a completely fabricated buckle for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated (see 6.2).

4.5.1 Inspection of components.

4.5.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in Table II for the test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements shall be applicable to the lot average.

Table II. TESTING OF COMPONENTS

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Charac-teristic	Rqm't Para	Test Method	Rqm't applicable to lot average	#determ per sample unit	Results Reported as	Sample Unit
Copper base alloy (1 lb)	Chemical composition	3.3.1	4.6.5	X	2 for each element	Nearest 0.1% for each element	4 oz of material

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4.5.1.1.1 Certification of compliance. Materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of the contractor's certificate of compliance for requirements specified in applicable paragraphs of this specification.

COMPONENTS	CHARACTERISTICS	ROM'T PARA
Screw post & thumb nut	Material identification	3.3.2
Hard Solder	Material identification and melting point	3.3.3
Gold for plating	Material identification	3.3.4
Lacquer	Material identification	3.3.5

4.5.1.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplished of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements.

REQUIREMENT, OPERATION OR ASSEMBLY	ROM'T PARA
Gold plating of coat of arms	3.7.1
Soldering of screw posts to back of Coat of Arms	3.5
Thickness of metal for design	B-6-6, B-6-6A or B-6-32 (TIOH drawings)

4.5.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.5.2.1 Visual examination of the buckle. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 22 inches. The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.5.2.1.1 and 4.5.2.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.5.2.1.3. The unit of product for the examinations in 4.5.2.1.1 and 4.5.2.1.2 shall be one completely fabricated buckle.

4.5.2.1.1 Examination of buckle for defects in color, finish, design, construction and workmanship. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

TABLE III. DEFECTS

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION Major	(*)	Minor
Color and finish	Color and finish of buckle does not compare favorably with the standard sample.....	-	*	-
	Pits, scale, pin holes, crack, rupture, segregation or foreign inclusion.....	-	*	-
	Not gold plated.....	x	-	-
	Buff, drag or cloudy finish.....	-	*	-

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TABLE III. DEFECTS (Continued)

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION Major	(*)	Minor
	Any plated area cut-through, shaded, peeled, or blistered	x	-	-
	Discoloration such as spot, stain, or speck	-	*	-
	Not clean or foreign matter imbedded	-	*	-
Plating	Not plated when required	*	-	-
	Not type specified	*	-	-
	Not smooth, continuous or adherent	*	-	-
	Cut through or porous	*	-	-
Lacquer	Not lacquered when required	x	-	-
	Foreign matter embedded in finish, i.e., lint, dust, etc	-	*	-
	Hazy, rainbow effect, cloudy, or powdering	-	*	-
	Not smooth, continuous or adherent, i.e., flaking, blistering, peeling or has run/sag	-	-	*
	Not set to touch, i.e., tacky when gentle pressure is applied to coating	-	-	x
Design	Details altered, does not conform to Government hub, drawing, or standard sample	x	-	-
	Any detail struck over resulting in double impression	-	*	-
	Any significant detail not clear, marred, missing, reduced or obliterated, i.e., does not compare favorably with approved sample	-	*	-
	Any area not pierced as indicated by drawing or standard sample	x	-	-
	Any warp, twist, or distortion producing irregular surface contour or outline	x	-	-
	Not dapped as indicated by standard sample or drawing	x	-	-
Workmanship	Metal marks such as nicks, cracks, dents, digs, gouges or scratches	-	*	-
	Not trimmed to die-struck edge	-	-	x
	Die-struck edge not well defined	-	-	x
	Edge not die struck	-	*	-
	Pinhole, crack or rupture	-	*	-
	Any sharp or rough edge, burr, drag or step or tool marks	-	*	-
	Coat of arms not closely dapped to fit contour of the buckle	x	-	-
	Any component missing, bent, twisted, broken, deformed or otherwise impaired	-	*	-
	Screw post missing	x	-	-
	Movement of slide bar is restricted	-	*	-

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TABLE III. DEFECTS (Continued)

EXAMINE	DEFECT	CLASSIFICATION Major	(*)	Minor
	Not pierced when required.....	x	-	-
	Piercing not clean and smooth.....	-	*	-
	Piercing operation distorts insignia.....	-	*	-
	Coat of Arms out of alignment.....	x	-	-
	Any area burned or reduced in soldering or acid cleaning.....	-	*	-
	Soldered area not clean or smooth, i.e., flux or excess solder not removed.....	-	*	-
	Penetration of marking to opposite surface, unevenness, or distortion.....	x	-	-
Soldering	Component parts not completely joined by solder or any perceptible opening between component parts.....	x	-	-
	Joints not clean and smooth, i.e., flux or excess solder not removed.....	-	-	x
	Burned or reduced areas.....	x	-	-
	Not silver solder.....	x	-	-
Assembly	Center line of coat of arms out of alignment.	x	-	-
	Coat of arms not securely mounted on the buckle, i.e., one or more thumb nuts missing	x	-	-
	Thumb nuts not securely tightened.....	-	-	x
Marking	Missing illegible, incorrect or incomplete...	-	-	x
	Conspicuously placed.....	-	*	-

4.5.2.1.2 Examination of the buckle for defects in dimensions. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.5.2.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). The inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection Level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For defects applicable to 4.5.2.1.1	I	0.065	2.5
For defects applicable to 4.5.2.1.2	S-3	(one class)	4.0

4.5.2.2 End item testing. Testing of the completely fabricated buckle shall be performed in accordance with Table IV for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be one buckle. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. Requirements are applicable to the individual unit.

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TABLE IV. TESTING OF END ITEM

Characteristic	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method	# determ Per Sample /Unit	Results Reported as
Acid test for gold plating	3.3.4	4.6.1	1	Pass or Fail
Tests for lacquer:				
Liver of sulfur	3.3.5	4.6.2	1	Pass or Fail
Tackiness test	3.3.5	4.6.3	1	Pass of Fail
Test for soldered joints	3.3.3	4.6.4	3	Pass or Fail

4.5.3 Examination for count of buckles for intermediate containers. Buckles packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (intermediate container). The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers. Any box containing less than the specified marked quantity of buckles shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per sample unit.

4.5.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of Section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

EXAMINE	DEFECT
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or taping, inadequate strapping. Bulging or distortion of containers.
Content	Number of intermediate packages is more or less than required.

4.6 Tests.

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4.6.1 Acid test for gold plating. The test acid shall be applied as follows: Place a drop of acid of not less than 1/16 inch (0.16 cm) in diameter on three different spots on the front face of the buckle allowing the drops to remain for not less than two (2) minutes during which time the surface of the buckle shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.7.4. A minimum of two spots must withstand the acid test. The test acid shall be applied at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees Fahrenheit) and shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of chemically pure nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water. If the test buckle has been lacquered, the lacquer shall be removed prior to testing.

4.6.2 Liver of sulfur test. Buckles shall be immersed in a 2 percent by weight chemically pure liver of sulfur (potassium sulfide) water solution at a temperature of 100 degrees Fahrenheit ± 10 degrees Fahrenheit for a period of 3 minutes. The buckles shall then be removed and rinsed in warm, then cold, then hot water, after which it shall be wiped gently with an absorbent cellulose material or whirled to remove residual moisture, allowed to dry at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees Fahrenheit) for one (1) hour and then be examined to determined compliance with 3.7.5.

4.6.3 Tackiness test. At room temperature (60 to 80 degrees Fahrenheit), press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable to being exerted between thumb and two fingers, after which the pressure shall be released and the buckle inspected to determine compliance with 3.7.5.

4.6.4 Tests for hard soldered joints. Hard soldered joints to be tested shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1075 degrees Fahrenheit ± 5 degrees Fahrenheit for not less than 15 minutes. While at this temperature, the items shall be lifted by the coat of arms or soldered edge and the joints examined for compliance with 3.5.1.3 and 3.5.2.3.

4.6.5 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with Test Method No. 111.1 of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.3.1.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each buckle shall be completely enclosed in a wrap of not less than three thickness of tissue paper conforming to Type I, Class 1 of UU-P-553. Ends of the wrap shall be folded back to prevent unwrapping. Each wrapped buckle shall be packaged in a set-up paperboard box conforming to Variety 1, Class A, Style 4 of PPP-B-676. Inside dimensions of the paperboard box shall be 3-1/2 inches (8.89 cm) in length, 2-1/2 inches (6.35 cm) in width and 7/8 inch (2.22 cm) in depth.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Sixty buckles packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be placed flat, three in length, four in width and five deep in a

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snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to Type SF, Class Domestic, Grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2 Commercial. Buckles packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Commercial. Buckles packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Palletization. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load Type 1A of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C, K and L or O or P. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. The pallet shall be 4-way, Type I, Class 1, Style 1, Size A, Wood Group I, II, III or IV of MIL-P-15011, or, 4-way, Type IV, V or VIII, Class 1, Style A, Size 2, Wood Group I, II, III or IV, Grade A of NN-P-71. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The buckles covered by this specification are intended to be used as an accessory to the uniforms worn by officers and enlisted personnel of honor units and the Army Band during formal military ceremonies.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1).

c. Whether a standard sample is to be furnished (see 3.1).

d. When a first article is not required (see 3.2).

e. Drawing (see 2.1.2 and 3.5).

f. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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g. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item should be a preproduction sample, a first production sample or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completed buckle. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.4 Government-loaned property. The contracting officer should arrange to loan the property listed in 3.8.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ceremonial
Coat of Arms
Insignia

Custodians:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Army - GL
DLA - CT

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

(Project No. 8315-0367)

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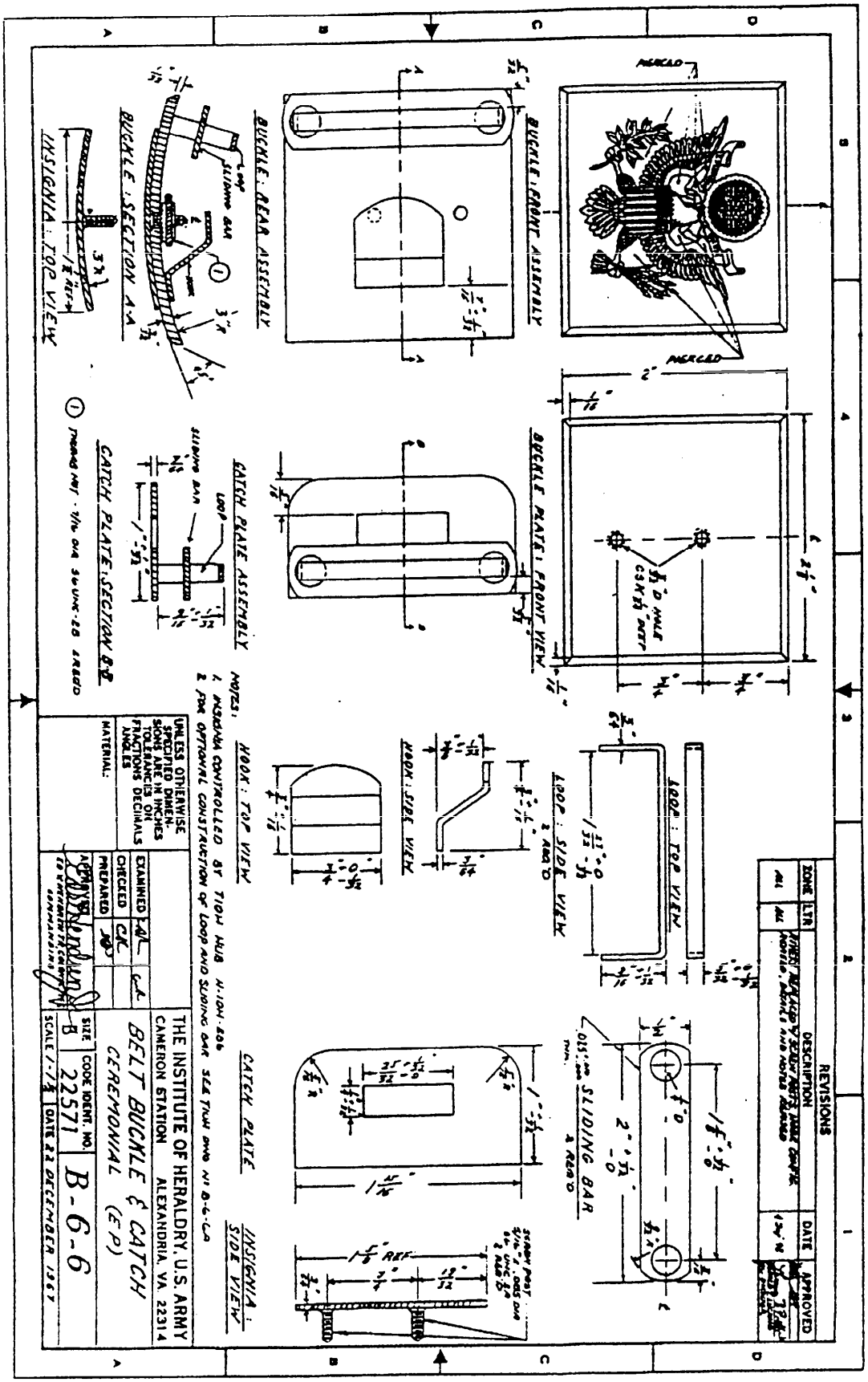


FIGURE 1. Belt Buckle & Catch, Ceremonial (EP)

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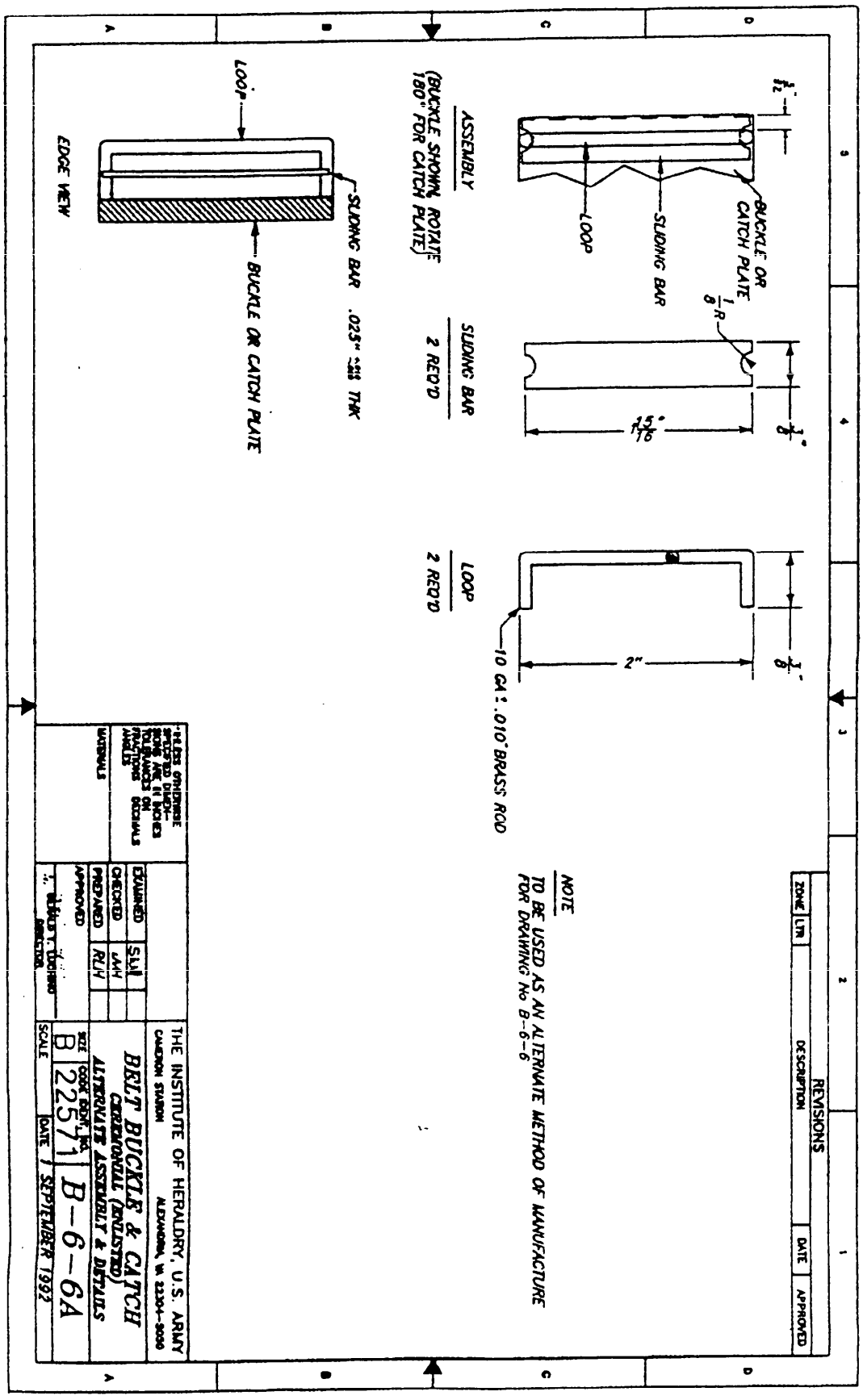


FIGURE 2. Belt Buckle & Catch, Ceremonial (Enlisted), Alternate Assembly & Details

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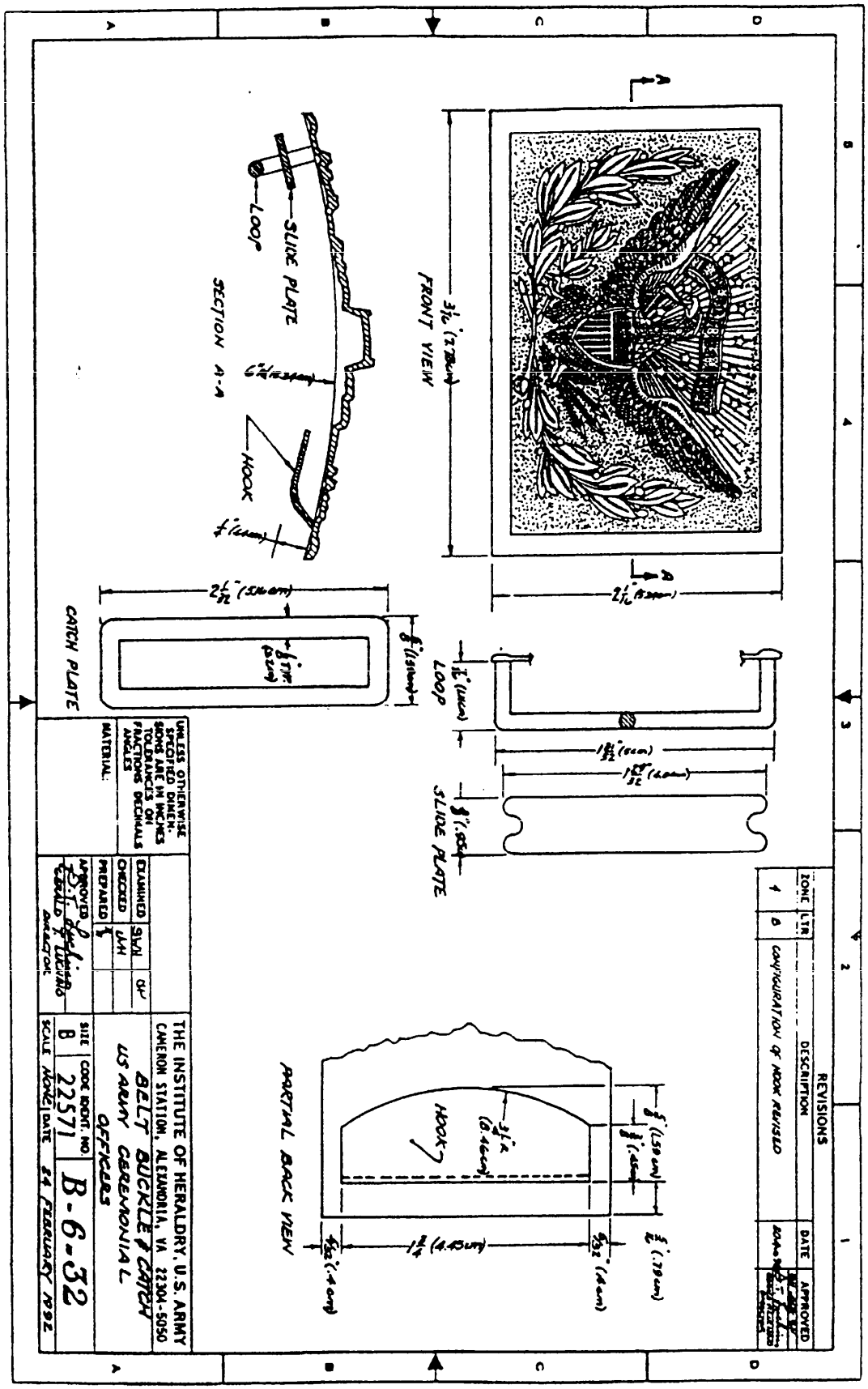


FIGURE 3. Belt Buckle & Catch, U.S. Army Ceremonial, Officers

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-B-14656	921002

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

BUCKLE AND CATCH, CEREMONIAL, ARMY

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
The Institute of Heraldry	(703) 274-6636	284-6636
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Bldg 15, Technical & Production Division Cameron Station Alexandria, VA 22304-5050	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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